

young man who favored colorful clothing and spent his free time walking the streets of Florence. If Leonardo was at all troubled by his lack of work or frustrated by the absence of progress in his career, he was very good at hiding it.



Sometimes, while he was out and about, Leonardo would buy a caged bird that was being offered for sale. His intention was not to take the bird home to enjoy its company. Rather, he would simply open the cage and let the imprisoned bird fly away.

Leonardo was also known for following



people—particularly anyone that he felt had an unusual feature, whether a beard or particular head of hair. Now it wasn't Leonardo's aim to make fun of whoever had caught his eye. He was just